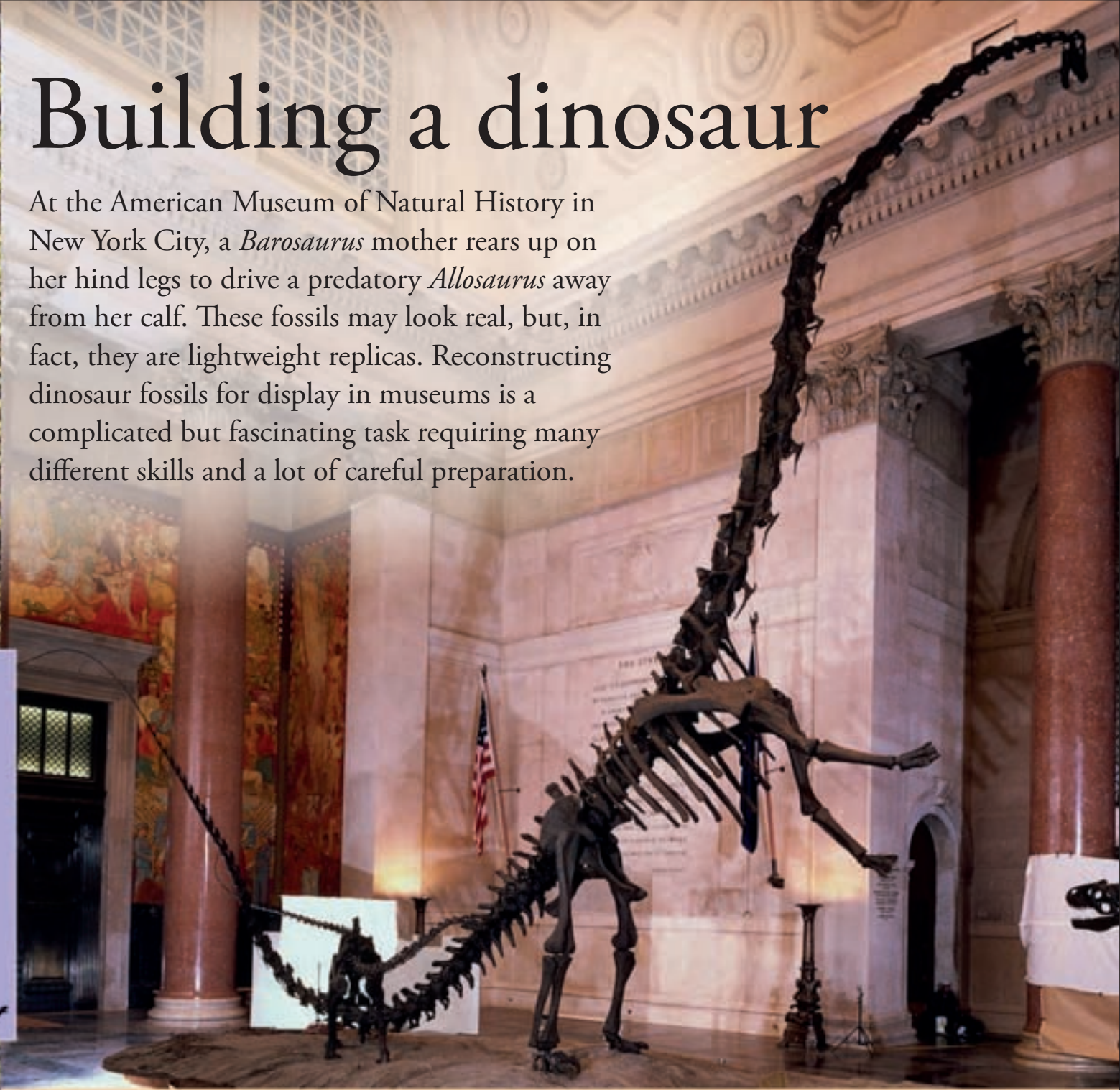


# Building a dinosaur

At the American Museum of Natural History in New York City, a *Barosaurus* mother rears up on her hind legs to drive a predatory *Allosaurus* away from her calf. These fossils may look real, but, in fact, they are lightweight replicas. Reconstructing dinosaur fossils for display in museums is a complicated but fascinating task requiring many different skills and a lot of careful preparation.



## PUTTING TOGETHER A DINOSAUR



▲ Careful planning is essential before the skeleton is constructed. Every bone is labeled and marked on a plan to show where it belongs.



▲ Here the ribs of the *Barosaurus* are joined to part of its backbone. The backbone is supported by a metal frame.



▲ The hind legs and pelvis (hip bones) are lowered into position in the museum by a small crane.



▲ The skeleton of the attacking *Allosaurus* is also assembled. It will face *Barosaurus* in the display.